PATRICIANCOLLEGEOFARTSAND SCIENCE

ANINTERNSHIPREPORTOFHUMANRESOURCESPRACTICES IN

A COMPANY

DEPARTMENTOFMANAGEMENT

SUMMERINTERNSHIPAT THE

TIMES OF INDIA

Submitted In the partial fulfillment of

BachelorofBusinessAdministrationDegreeBy

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UndertheGuidanceof

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INTERNSHIPCERTIFICATE

This is to certify that the summer internship report submitted by **Mr. VENKATARAMAN K (412302831)** is a partial fulfilment of the requirements for the award of Bachelor of Business Administration(BBA).Thisreportisanoriginalworksubmittedbythestudentasarequirement for the Completion.

Date:

Place:

Head ofthe Department

STUDENTDECLARATION

I by **Mr. VENKATARAMAN K (412302831)**hereby declare that the summer internship report submittedbymefortheDegreeofMasterinBachelorofBusinessAdministration(BBA)ismy original work and has not formed the award of any degree earlier.

MR.VENKATARAMAN K(412302831)

Date:

Place:

MR.VENKATARAMAN K

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EXECUTIVESUMMARY

EXECUTIVESUMMARY:

Thisreporthighlightsmyinternshipexperienceat*TheTimesofIndia*(TOI)inthe*CallCenter/Customer Care*department, which Iundertookfrom 22nd July2025 to 13th August 2025. Asoneof India's most recognized media outlets, TOI gave me the unique opportunity to engage with its vast customer base, providing invaluable exposure to the workings of a major media corporation.

My primary responsibilities included interacting with subscribers, handling their inquiries, managing subscriptions, resolving issues related to delivery, and offering customer support for both print and digitalservices.Thisinternshipallowedmetogainfirsthandinsightintothesignificanceofmaintaining a positive relationship with customers in an era where media consumption is increasingly shifting to digital platforms.

Theexperiencetaughtmetheimportanceofpatience,communication,andempathywhileworkingunder pressure,aswellastherolecustomerserviceplaysinsustainingamediabrand'sreputation.Furthermore, I was able to observe and participate in daily operations, improving my understanding of both the technical and interpersonal aspects of customer care.

This report outlines my roles and responsibilities, the skills I developed, key findings, and suggestions for enhancing both the internship experience and TOI's customer care services. It concludes with a reflection on how the internship has prepared me for future endeavors in customer service and media-related fields.

INTRODUCTION

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INTRODUCTION:

The internship at *The Times of India* provided a rare opportunity to work within one of the largest and most influential media organizations in India. Over the course of three weeks, from 22nd July 2025 to 13th August 2025, I was placed in the *Call Center / Customer Care* department at the TOI office in T Nagar.This department playsapivotal rolein managingsubscriberrelationships, respondingto customer queries, and addressing concerns related to TOI's print and digital services.

The internship aimed to provide hands-on experience in the media industry, particularly in customer service, and to develop core skills like communication, problem-solving, time management, and technical proficiency. I was assigned to various tasks ranging from addressing customer complaints to promoting new subscription packages. Through these responsibilities, I gained exposure to the fast-paced environment of a major media company and learned how customer care integrates with broader operational functions.

Thepurposeofthisreportistodescribemyexperiences,provideinsightsintotheorganizationalstructure and operations of TOI, and share the lessons learned during my internship. The report also offers recommendations for improving customer service practices, based on my observations and feedback during the internship period.

COMPANY PROFILE

COMPANYPROFILE

Name: The Times of India (TOI)

Managing Director: Mr. G. Madhu

Headquarters: Mumbai,Maharashtra

ParentCompany: Bennett,Coleman&Co. Ltd. (BCCL)

Industry: Print&DigitalMedia

Established:3rdNovember1838(187yearsoldasof 2025)

CompanyType: PrivateLimited

Status: Active

Locations: TamilNadu,AndhraPradesh,Telangana,Karnataka

Employees: Thousandsacross India

Overview&History

The Times of India is one of the oldest and most respected English-language newspapers in India, originallyfoundedin1838as*TheBombayTimesandJournalofCommerce*.Itwasrenamed*TheTimes of India* in 1861 and later came under Indian ownership in 1946. Today, TOI operates under the Sahu Jain family and is part of the Times Group (BCCL), India's largest media conglomerate.

Vision &Mission

- **Vision:**Toenrichthelivesofreaderswithaccurate,timely,andhigh-qualitycontentacross platforms.
- **Mission:**Topromoteinformedaction throughresponsiblejournalismandinclusivereporting.

CoreValues

- Integrity& Accuracy
- Innovation&Technology
- Reader-CentricApproach

- SocialResponsibility

Products&Services

- **DailyNewspaper**(National&RegionalEditions)
- **TOIWebsite&MobileApp**–Real-timeupdates,videos,ande-paperaccess
- **Classifieds& Ads** –Jobs, realestate, matrimonial, etc.
- **Supplements:**
  - *Chennai Times*–Citynews& entertainment
  - *EducationTimes* –Career&academicupdates
  - *TimesWellness,Ascent,Life,Classified*–Health,jobs,lifestyle,weekend ads

Digital Presence

TOI has adopted a digital-first strategy with platforms like Times Internet, TOI Plus (premium news), and strong multimedia journalism (videos, infographics, social media). The TOI app has millions of downloads and serves a global audience.

Leadership

- **ExecutiveDirector:** Mr. AhmedabadMohitJain
- **Non-ExecutiveDirectors:** Mr.Sunil Mittal,Mr.Gopal Vittal

Industry Position

- Over3 million dailycopies in circulation (2024)
- Distributedin 40+ countries
- RegularlyrankedamongIndia'smosttrustednews brands

CSR &Recognition

- **TeachIndia,Lead India,SavetheTiger** – Keysocial campaigns
- **TOIFAAwards**–HonoringBollywoodexcellence
- **GlobalMediaAwards** –Fordigitalinnovationand

WORKPROFILE

WORK PROFILE:

As an internin the*CallCenter/Customer Care* department,my role focused on providing high-quality support to TOI's diverse customer base, ensuring that all inquiries were addressed promptly and effectively. The department handled customer requests ranging from subscription issues to digital services, and I played an integral role in facilitating smooth communication between TOI and its subscribers.

Rolesand Responsibilities:

1. **CustomerInteraction& Support**:
    - Answered a high volume of incoming calls, emails, and social media queries from customers regarding subscription-related issues, delivery concerns, and requests for account changes.
    - Addressedbothroutineinquiries,suchasdeliveryschedulesandaccountupdates,aswell as more complex issues, such as complaints about service interruptions or billing discrepancies.
2. **SubscriptionManagement**:
    - Assisted customers in managing their subscriptions by helping with renewals, upgrades, cancellations, and modifications to their subscription plans.
    - Provided information about various subscription packages (print, digital, or combined) and guided customer son how to switchor upgrade to digital platforms,especially inlight of TOI’s shift towards digital-first services.
3. **ComplaintResolution**:
    - Worked closely with the operations and delivery teams to ensure prompt resolution of issues related to late or missed newspaper deliveries.
    - Assisted introubleshooting digital access issues,such as login problems with theTOI app or website, subscription activations, and payment failures.
4. **CustomerFeedback Collection**:
    - Collected and recorded customer feedback about TOI’s products and services, noting areas for improvement and recurring issues.
    - Analyzed customer sentiment and offered suggestions for improving the customer experience based on common complaints and queries.
5. **PromotingDigitalServices**:

- Guided customers through the process of signing up forTOI's digital platforms,including the website and mobile apps, and explained the benefits of digital subscriptions.
- Promoted various digital content offerings, such as exclusive articles, videos, and newsletters, which were increasingly being integrated into the TOI ecosystem.

6. **Training &KnowledgeEnhancement**:
   - Received training in using TOI's customer management software (CRM) and other internal tools for tracking customer interactions and processing subscriptions.
   - Participatedindailyteammeetingstoreviewperformancemetrics,discussbestpractices for handling customer queries, and learn new updates related to TOI’s products and services.

Skills Developed:

- **EffectiveCommunication**:Learned how to communicate clearly and professionally with customers, ensuring that their issues were addressed with empathy and efficiency.
- **Problem-Solving**:Gained experience in troubleshooting various issues,from subscription delivery problems to technical difficulties with digital content access.
- **TimeManagement**:Managed a large volume of customer interactions within tight timeframes, prioritizing urgent issues and ensuring no customer was left unassisted.
- **Technical Proficiency**: Became proficient in using CRM tools and other software to managecustomer data, track queries, and resolve complaints.
- **Customer Service Etiquette**: Developed a deep understanding of customer service principles, such as patience, active listening, and personalized communication.

FINDINGS&SUGGESTIONS

FINDINGS:

1. **Customer-CentricApproachisEssential**:
    - I found that TOI's success in maintaining a loyal customer base hinges on its ability to resolve issues quickly and effectively. A customer-centric approach, where every interaction is personalized and aimed at providingvalue,is crucial in fostering long-term relationships with subscribers.
2. **Importanceof TechnologyinCustomer Care**:
    - The role of technology in streamlining customer service became evident during my internship. CRM systems, automated alerts, and data-driven insights all contributed to improving response times and ensuring that customer issues were addressed promptly.
3. **DigitalTransition isChangingCustomer Needs**:
    - As more customers shift to digital media, there's a noticeable increase in queries about digital subscriptions, technical issues related to apps, and accessing exclusive online content.This emphasizesthe importance of adapting customer service strategies to cater to digital-first consumers.
4. **EmployeeTrainingisKey**:
    - Regular training for customer service agents is essential to ensure that they are well-equipped to handle diverse customer issues and keep up with the evolving product offerings of TOI, especially in the digital space.
5. **FeedbackLoopisCriticalforContinuous Improvement**:
    - I noticed that many customer complaints were recurring, particularly around late deliveries and billing issues. A structured feedback loop, where customer feedback is systematically analyzed and used to refine internal processes, could lead to significant improvements in service quality.

SUGGESTIONS:

Forthe Organization:

1. **EnhancedInternTrainingProgram**:
    - Implement a more comprehensive training program at the start of the internship that covers customer service tools, TOI's internal processes, and an overview of customer queriesandissues.This would allow interns to contribute more effectively from day one.
2. **CustomerServiceAutomation**:
    - The use of AI-powered chatbots or automated phone systems for handling basic queries (e.g., subscription renewals, delivery status) could free up call center agents to focus on more complex issues, improving both response time and service quality.
3. **FeedbackIntegrationforServiceImprovements**:
    - Regularly analyze customer feedback to identify recurring issues, and integrate this feedback into service improvements. For instance, addressing common complaints like delivery issues through more efficient logistics systems could significantly improve customer satisfaction.
4. **IncreasedCross-DepartmentalCollaboration**:
    - Encourage more interaction between the customer care department and other departments,such as the editorial,digital,and operationsteams.Understanding how each department impacts customer experiences can lead to a more holistic approach to problem-solving.
5. **Mobile-FriendlyToolsforCustomer Interaction**:
    - As many customers interact with TOI through mobile devices, implementing mobile-friendly CRM tools and subscription management systems would enhance both internal efficiency and the customer experience.

CONCLUSION

CONCLUSION:

My internship experience at **The Times of India – T Nagar Branch** from **22nd July 2025 to 13th August2025** has been bothenrichingandtransformative.Workinginthe**CallCenter/CustomerCare** department gave me a firsthand understanding of the vital role customer service plays in the success of amajormediaorganization.Igainedvaluablepracticalexposure tohandlingreal-timecustomerissues, promoting digital services, and utilizing CRM tools, all while enhancing key soft skills like communication, patience, and problem-solving.

Theinternship provided insight into how TOI, a legacymedia brand, is adaptingto the evolvingdigital landscape while maintaining strong customer relationships. It also revealed the challenges involved in balancing traditional print services with modern digital expectations. I learned that excellent customer service is not just about resolving problems—it's about creating a positive experience that reflects the organization's values and builds long-term trust.

Overall, this internship has prepared me for future roles in customer service and media, sharpened my understanding of organizational operations, and reinforced the importance of empathy, efficiency, and adaptability in any customer-facing profession. I am confident that the skills and knowledge I have acquired will serveas astrongfoundation as Imoveforward in myacademic and professional journey.